

A four-session role-play course · Lausanne, August 2026

The English Play Pack



Four theatrical sessions of ninety minutes for Lila, seven years old, starting from no English at all. Every session ends with a scene the two of you perform – both of you playing both roles.

WHAT IS INSIDE

Teacher sheets with the Greek meanings for you, word cards, full scripts in large type, three games per session, cut-out props – play money, a menu, an order pad, prescriptions, show tickets – and a diploma.

HOW TO PRINT

A4, single-sided, colour if you can, "background graphics" switched on. Print the whole pack once. Card pages and prop pages are meant to be cut along the dashed lines; keep everything in one box that only comes out at English time.

Eight rules for the grown-up

You are not a teacher and she is not a student. You are two actors with a hat. Read this page once before session one; it matters more than any of the word lists.

1. **The hat is the switch.**

When you put the hat on, English begins. When it comes off, English stops. A 90-minute lesson feels like homework; a hat that turns you into someone else feels like a game. Same 90 minutes.

2. **The Greek Button rescues, it does not replace.**

Cut out the red button on the props page. She may slap it any time and get ten seconds of Greek – then the hat is back on. Knowing the escape exists is what stops the panic that makes children refuse to speak.

3. **Never correct inside a scene.**

If she says "I are happy", you answer in character: "You are happy! I am happy too!" She hears the right form without being stopped. Correcting mid-scene teaches her that speaking is dangerous.

4. **Play every scene three times.**

Run 1 – you play both roles with a toy while she only watches and listens. Run 2 – she takes role A, reading or repeating after you. Run 3 – you swap. The third run is where the language actually sticks.

5. **Three to five words per line. Always the same words.**

Repetition is not boring for a beginner, it is the entire lesson. She needs to hear "How much is it?" thirty times, not thirty different questions.

6. **Silly beats perfect.**

A monster voice, a wrong price of one hundred francs, a customer who pays with a sock. If she laughs, she remembers. If she is bored, nothing sticks however correct it was.

7. **Stop a block early, never late.**

The moment her eyes drift, end that block and move to a movement game, even if five minutes are left. Ending on a high note is what makes her want the next session.

8. **Your accent does not matter.**

You are not the model of perfect English, you are her playmate in English. A parent playing enthusiastically in imperfect English beats a perfect recording she ignores.

The shape of every session

The same nine blocks every time, in the same order. A seven-year-old will not sit through ninety unbroken minutes of anything – but she will happily sit through nine short things she recognises. Predictability is what buys you the ninety minutes.

CLOCK	LENGTH	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS
0:00	5 min	Opening ritual	Hat on. Ring the bell. The same hello chant every single session.
0:05	10 min	Warm-up	Review game from last session. Session 1: the numbers chant.
0:15	15 min	New words	Word cards. Show, say, she repeats, she finds, she hides one.
0:30	10 min	Word game	Standing up, moving. Game 1 on the games sheet.
0:40	10 min	BREAK	Water, snack, no English at all. Protect this break.
0:50	15 min	The Play – run 1 & 2	You demo both roles, then she takes role A with the script in hand.
1:05	10 min	The Play – run 3	Swap roles. No script if she can manage.
1:15	10 min	Silly version	Same scene, wrong world. Let her invent the silliness.
1:25	5 min	Closing ritual	Star on the chart, hand her the home mission card, goodbye chant.

Why nine blocks and not three

A seven-year-old cannot sit through ninety unbroken minutes of anything, but she will happily sit through nine short things she recognises. Never reorder them and never skip the break – predictability is what buys you the ninety minutes.

The two chants and the card games

These four things never change from session one to session four. Everything else in the pack is new each time; these are the walls she leans on.

THE OPENING CHANT

Hello, hello, what's your name?
My name is _____, what's your name?
Nice to meet you! Nice to meet you!
Let's play, let's play, let's play in English!

THE CLOSING CHANT

Goodbye, goodbye, see you soon!
Goodbye, goodbye, that was fun!
One more star, one more day –
Bye-bye, bye-bye, hip hooray!

Clap on every stressed syllable and march on the spot. By session three she will start the chant herself before you do – that is the moment you know the ritual has taken.

FOUR WAYS TO USE ANY SET OF WORD CARDS

1 • Show and say

Hold one up, say it, she repeats. All twelve, twice.
Fast, no explanations, no writing.

2 • Grab it

Cards face up on the floor. You say a word, she slaps the card. Then she says a word and you slap – losing on purpose is the point.

3 • What is missing?

She shuts her eyes, you steal a card. She names the missing one in English. Start with six cards, not twelve.

4 • Hide and seek

Hide the cards round the room. Each one she finds, she shouts its name before she may keep it.

Lila's star chart

Six stars per session, one for each block she finishes. Colour a star in front of her, out loud, and say why. Stars are given for trying, never for being correct – the day you withhold a star for a mistake is the day the pack stops working.

Session 1 Who Are You?	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
Session 2 The Little Shop	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
Session 3 The Little Café	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
Session 4 The Animal Doctor	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆

THE GREEK BUTTON – CUT THIS OUT



She slaps it, you both speak Greek for ten seconds, then it is English again. Let her use it as often as she likes in session one. She will use it less each week without being told to.

Session 1

Who Are You?



Meeting somebody for the first time

By the end she can walk up to a stranger, say hello, give her name and her age, ask for theirs, and say goodbye. Nothing else. That is a full 90 minutes for a beginner and it is the foundation everything else sits on.

TWELVE WORDS

**hello**

γεια σου

**happy**

χαρούμενη

**goodbye**

αντίο

**sad**

λυπημένη

**yes**

ναι

**tired**

κουρασμένη

**no**

όχι

**hungry**

πεινασμένη

**please**

σε παρακαλώ

**friend**

φίλη

**thank you**

ευχαριστώ

**neighbour**

γείτονας

THREE THINGS WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

- Do not teach "I am" versus "I'm". Teach only "I'm". Rules come years later.
- The numbers chant (opposite page) is the warm-up of every session from now on. Two minutes, clapping, marching. She will need one to ten for the shop next week.
- If she answers in Greek during the play, do not stop. Repeat her sentence in English as if agreeing, and carry on.

Greek is printed on your sheets only. Her cards and her script are English-only on purpose – the moment a Greek word sits next to an English one, she reads the Greek and the English becomes decoration.

Session 1 · Who Are You?

The ten sentences she will actually use

Say each one, she repeats, twice round. Then hide the sheet – from that point on they only ever appear inside a scene. A sentence drilled at a table is forgotten by Thursday; the same sentence said to a shopkeeper is not.

Hello! / Hi!

Γεια σου!

What's your name?

Πώς σε λένε;

My name is Lila.

Με λένε Λίλα.

How old are you?

Πόσο χρονών είσαι;

I'm seven.

Είμαι επτά.

How are you?

Τι κάνεις;

I'm fine, thank you.

Καλά, ευχαριστώ.

Nice to meet you!

Χάρηκα!

Come in!

Πέρασε μέσα!

Goodbye! See you tomorrow!

Αντίο! Τα λέμε αύριο!

If she freezes

Say the first two words of her line and stop. Nine times out of ten she finishes it. If she still cannot, say the whole line cheerfully as your own and move on – never leave her standing in silence, and never let the scene stop because of a missing word.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES · SESSION 1 WORD CARDS · FOUR WAYS TO USE THEM ARE ON THE "SESSION SHAPE" SHEET



hello



goodbye



yes



no



please



thank you



happy



sad



tired



hungry



friend



neighbour

Session 1 · The Play

The New Neighbour

A – the visitor**B – the neighbour at home**

- A** Knock, knock!
- B** Who is it?
- A** Hello! I'm your new neighbour.
- B** Hello! Come in, come in!
- A** Thank you.
- B** What's your name?
- A** My name is Lila. What's your name?
- B** My name is Papa. Nice to meet you!
- A** Nice to meet you too.
- B** How old are you?
- A** I'm seven. How are you today?
- B** I'm fine, thank you. And you?
- A** I'm happy! And I'm hungry!
- B** Would you like a biscuit?
- A** Yes, please!
- B** Here you are.
- A** Thank you! Goodbye!
- B** Goodbye! See you tomorrow!

The set

A chair is the door. One of you stands outside and knocks. Have a plate of biscuits ready – a real biscuit at the right line is worth ten repetitions.

Props

A chair (the door) · a plate of biscuits · the hat

Run it three times. You alone with a toy · she takes the first role · swap. Never fewer than three.

Session 1

Games & the silly versions

THREE GAMES

10 MIN

The Hello Hat

Pass the hat back and forth. Whoever wears it must introduce themselves with a brand-new invented name and age: "My name is Banana. I'm forty-two." Invented names are the trick – it removes the fear of getting her own answer wrong.

10 MIN

Freeze and Greet

Clap a rhythm and both walk around the room. When you stop clapping, both freeze, turn to each other and do the full greeting. Each round, hold up a different feeling card so the "How are you?" answer changes.

5 MIN

The Toy Parade

Line up five toys on the sofa. She introduces each one to you: "This is Bunny. She is three." Toys are easier to speak for than herself.

FOUR SILLY VERSIONS OF THE SAME SCENE

Play these after the straight version has worked twice. The words stay identical; only the world changes. This is where the repetition she needs stops feeling like repetition.

The monster next door

Play B as a monster. Same lines, but "My name is Grrmp. I'm one hundred years old."

The cat neighbour

Every line starts with "Meow". "Meow – my name is Cleo." She will insist on being the cat.

The robot

Flat voice, one word per second, arms stiff. Great for a child who rushes and swallows words.

The tiny voice / the giant voice

Whole scene whispered, then whole scene shouted. Pure repetition disguised as chaos.

Home mission after this session: Every morning this week, the first words of the day are English. She knocks on your bedroom door: "Good morning! How are you?" You answer, then ask her back.

SESSION 1 PROP · THE NUMBERS CHANT · CUT INTO CARDS OR KEEP AS ONE SHEET

One to twelve**1****one**

ένα

2**two**

δύο

3**three**

τρία

4**four**

τέσσερα

5**five**

πέντε

6**six**

έξι

7**seven**

εφτά

8**eight**

οκτώ

9**nine**

εννιά

10**ten**

δέκα

11**eleven**

έντεκα

12**twelve**

δώδεκα

March on the spot and chant one to ten every session as the warm-up, two minutes, no more. Then count real things: fingers, stairs, spoons, the toys on the sofa. She needs one to ten fluently before session two, because the shop runs on it.

SESSION 1 PROP · FEELING CARDS FOR "HOW ARE YOU?"



happy



sad



tired



hungry



angry



excited

Hold one up in the middle of a scene and the answer to "How are you?" must change. Later, let her hold the cards and choose – being the one who decides is worth twenty minutes of attention.

Session 2

The Little Shop



Buying and selling, with real prices and real change

By the end she can run a shop counter in English: greet a customer, name ten products, ask and answer a price, take money and give change. This is the session she has been asking for since she started playing cashier.

TWELVE WORDS


apple

μήλο


eggs

αυγά


banana

μπανάνα


water

νερό


bread

ψωμί


tomato

ντομάτα


milk

γάλα


ice cream

παγωτό


cheese

τυρί


money

λεφτά


chocolate

σοκολάτα


bag

σακούλα

THREE THINGS WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

- Keep prices between one and ten francs so the sums stay inside the numbers she knows.
- Let her be the shopkeeper first. The shopkeeper has the harder lines but the power, and she will fight for that role – use it.
- "Can I have" is the single most useful phrase in this pack. Drill it more than any other.

Greek is printed on your sheets only. Her cards and her script are English-only on purpose – the moment a Greek word sits next to an English one, she reads the Greek and the English becomes decoration.

Session 2 · The Little Shop

The ten sentences she will actually use

Say each one, she repeats, twice round. Then hide the sheet – from that point on they only ever appear inside a scene. A sentence drilled at a table is forgotten by Thursday; the same sentence said to a shopkeeper is not.

Good morning! Welcome to my shop!

Καλημέρα! Καλώς ήρθατε!

Can I help you?

Μπορώ να βοηθήσω;

Can I have some bread, please?

Μπορώ να έχω λίγο ψωμί, παρακαλώ;

How much is it?

Πόσο κάνει;

It is eight francs.

Κάνει οκτώ φράγκα.

Here you are.

Ορίστε.

Anything else?

Κάτι άλλο;

No, thank you. That's all.

Όχι, ευχαριστώ. Αυτά.

Here is your change.

Ορίστε τα ρέστα σας.

Have a nice day!

Καλή σας μέρα!

If she freezes

Say the first two words of her line and stop. Nine times out of ten she finishes it. If she still cannot, say the whole line cheerfully as your own and move on – never leave her standing in silence, and never let the scene stop because of a missing word.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES · SESSION 2 WORD CARDS · FOUR WAYS TO USE THEM ARE ON THE "SESSION SHAPE" SHEET



apple



banana



bread



milk



cheese



chocolate



eggs



water



tomato



ice cream



money



bag

Session 2 · The Play

The Little Shop

S – the shopkeeper**C – the customer**

- S** Good morning! Welcome to my shop!
- C** Good morning!
- S** Can I help you?
- C** Yes, please. Can I have some bread?
- S** Of course. Here you are.
- C** Thank you.
- S** Anything else?
- C** Yes. Two apples, please.
- S** Two apples. Here you are.
- C** How much is it?
- S** The bread is four francs. The apples are four francs.
- S** That is eight francs, please.
- C** Here you are. Ten francs.
- S** Thank you. Here is your change: two francs.
- C** Thank you! Goodbye!
- S** Goodbye! Have a nice day!

The set

The kitchen table is the counter. Put out the real food from the word cards if you have it, with a printed price tag standing next to each. The play money must be counted out note by note, out loud.

Props

Price tags · play money · a shopping bag · real fruit if possible

Run it three times. You alone with a toy · she takes the first role · swap. Never fewer than three.

Session 2

Games & the silly versions

THREE GAMES

10 MIN

Price Hunt

Spread the price tags on the items. You call out "Four francs!" and she must run and grab the right item and shout its name in English. Then swap – she calls, you run. Her calling out is the half that teaches her to produce numbers, not just recognise them.

10 MIN

The Shopping List

Hand her one of the printed picture lists. She must buy all three items from your shop, in English, and count the money. Four lists are provided so it can run four rounds.

5 MIN

Cash Register Race

You shout a price, she has three seconds to lay out the exact notes. "Seven francs!" – five plus two. Counting money out loud is the fastest way to fix numbers one to ten.

FOUR SILLY VERSIONS OF THE SAME SCENE

Play these after the straight version has worked twice. The words stay identical; only the world changes. This is where the repetition she needs stops feeling like repetition.

The Crazy Shop

The shop only sells impossible things: a cloud, a dragon, Monday. Prices are absurd: "One dragon? One hundred francs!"

Sorry, no bananas!

The shopkeeper is out of everything. Whatever the customer asks: "Sorry! No bananas!" The customer must keep asking for something new – that is ten repetitions of the question.

The customer with no money

She tries to pay with a sock, a shoe, a hug. "Can I pay with a sock?" "No! Five francs!"

The shop for giants

Everything is enormous and everything costs one franc. Say every price in a booming voice.

Home mission after this session: She is the cashier at dinner this week. Nobody gets bread until they ask her in English and pay with a play note. She gives the change and says the price.

SESSION 2 PROP · PLAY MONEY · CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

PLAY FRANCS 1 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 1 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 2 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 2 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 5 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 5 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 10 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 10 The English Play Pack · Lausanne

SESSION 2 PROP · PLAY MONEY · CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

PLAY FRANCS 1 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 2 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 2 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 5 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 5 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 10 The English Play Pack · Lausanne
PLAY FRANCS 10 The English Play Pack · Lausanne	PLAY FRANCS 10 The English Play Pack · Lausanne

SESSION 2 PROP · PRICE TAGS · FOLD AND STAND NEXT TO EACH ITEM

 2 francs apple	 3 francs banana	 4 francs bread
 5 francs milk	 6 francs cheese	 7 francs chocolate
 8 francs eggs	 1 francs water	 3 francs tomato
 9 francs ice cream	? francs write your own	? francs write your own

Keep every price between one and ten so the sums stay inside the numbers she knows. Two blank tags are there for the day she wants to invent a shop of her own – let her.

SESSION 2 PROP · SHOPPING LISTS · ONE PER ROUND

SHOPPING LIST 1

**bread**☐**milk**☐**apple**☐

Say: "Can I have ..., please?"

SHOPPING LIST 2

**cheese**☐**water**☐**banana**☐

Say: "Can I have ..., please?"

SHOPPING LIST 3

**eggs**☐**tomato**☐**chocolate**☐

Say: "Can I have ..., please?"

SHOPPING LIST 4

**ice cream**☐**bread**☐**water**☐

Say: "Can I have ..., please?"

How to run it

Hand her a list face down. She turns it over, walks to your shop and must buy all three items in English, ticking each box. She pays at the end and you give change. Time her with a phone stopwatch from round two onwards – the clock turns a language drill into a sport.

SESSION 2 PROP · THE SHOP SIGN · CUT OUT, FOLD IN THE MIDDLE, STAND IT UP

OPEN

WELCOME TO MY SHOP

SEE YOU TOMORROW

CLOSED

She turns the sign at the start and end of every scene and says the line printed under it. Small ceremonies like this are what make her treat the game as real.

Session 3

The Little Café



Ordering food, serving it, and paying the bill

By the end she can be a waiter and a guest: seat someone, hand a menu, take an order of two things, serve them, and ask for the bill. New grammar smuggled in: "I would like" and "Would you like...?"

TWELVE WORDS

**pizza**

πίτσα

**cake**

κέικ

**pasta**

μακαρόνια

**ice cream**

παγωτό

**soup**

σούπα

**juice**

χυμός

**salad**

σαλάτα

**tea**

τσάι

**chicken**

κοτόπουλο

**hot**

ζεστό

**rice**

ρύζι

**cold**

κρύο

THREE THINGS WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

- "I would like" is one lump of sound to her – teach it as a single word, iwouldlike. Do not explain "would".
- Real food beats plastic food. Even one real slice of bread on a plate changes the game.
- This is the session to invite Mum in as a second guest for the last ten minutes. An audience raises the effort enormously.

Greek is printed on your sheets only. Her cards and her script are English-only on purpose – the moment a Greek word sits next to an English one, she reads the Greek and the English becomes decoration.

Session 3 · The Little Café

The ten sentences she will actually use

Say each one, she repeats, twice round. Then hide the sheet – from that point on they only ever appear inside a scene. A sentence drilled at a table is forgotten by Thursday; the same sentence said to a shopkeeper is not.

Good afternoon! A table for two?

Καλησπέρα! Τραπέζι για δύο;

This way, please.

Από εδώ, παρακαλώ.

Here is the menu.

Ορίστε ο κατάλογος.

What would you like?

Τι θα θέλατε;

I would like a pizza, please.

Θα ήθελα μια πίτσα, παρακαλώ.

Would you like a drink?

Θα θέλατε κάτι να πιείτε;

Yes, please. / No, thank you.

Ναι, παρακαλώ. / Όχι, ευχαριστώ.

Enjoy your meal!

Καλή όρεξη!

It is delicious!

Είναι νόστιμο!

The bill, please.

Τον λογαριασμό, παρακαλώ.

If she freezes

Say the first two words of her line and stop. Nine times out of ten she finishes it. If she still cannot, say the whole line cheerfully as your own and move on – never leave her standing in silence, and never let the scene stop because of a missing word.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES · SESSION 3 WORD CARDS · FOUR WAYS TO USE THEM ARE ON THE "SESSION SHAPE" SHEET



pizza



pasta



soup



salad



chicken



rice



cake



ice cream



juice



tea



hot



cold

Session 3 · The Play

The Little Café

W – the waiter**G – the guest**

W Good afternoon! Welcome to our café!

G Good afternoon. A table for one, please.

W This way, please. Here is the menu.

G Thank you.

W What would you like?

G I would like a pizza, please.

W One pizza. Would you like a drink?

G Yes, please. An apple juice.

W Very good. One moment, please.

W Here you are. One pizza and one apple juice. Enjoy your meal!

G Thank you. Mmm! It is delicious!

W Would you like a cake?

G No, thank you. The bill, please.

W Of course. That is twelve francs.

G Here you are. Thank you! Goodbye!

W Thank you! Goodbye! See you soon!

The set

Lay one place at the table properly – cloth, glass, folded napkin. Print the menu and stand it up. A tea towel over the waiter's arm is worth more than any flashcard.

Props

The printed menu · order pad · bill slips · a tea towel
· a real glass of juice

Run it three times. You alone with a toy · she takes the first role · swap. Never fewer than three.

Session 3

Games & the silly versions

THREE GAMES

10 MIN

Waiter's Memory

You order three things with the pad taken away. She has to repeat the order back correctly before she is allowed to "bring" it. Start with two things, go to four when she is winning.

5 MIN

Hot or Cold

Hold up a food card. She shouts "The soup is hot!" and blows on her hands, or "The ice cream is cold!" and shivers. The mime is what fixes the adjective.

10 MIN

Menu Bingo

Both take a bingo card. Take turns being the waiter calling out dishes. First to cross a full row shouts "Bingo! Enjoy your meal!"

FOUR SILLY VERSIONS OF THE SAME SCENE

Play these after the straight version has worked twice. The words stay identical; only the world changes. This is where the repetition she needs stops feeling like repetition.

The Yuck Café

Use the second menu: soup with a shoe, spaghetti with socks, cold tea with sand. The guest tastes it and says "It is terrible!" This teaches the opposite of delicious.

The waiter who drops everything

Every dish falls. "Oh no! Sorry! One moment, please!" and the order starts again. Free repetition, and she will cry with laughter.

The very hungry guest

She orders ten things in a row. The waiter must repeat the whole list back. Brutal memory work that does not feel like work.

The café for animals

Guest is a dog and can only order things a dog would want. The waiter must stay polite.

Home mission after this session: Saturday breakfast, she is the waiter. She takes the whole family's order on the printed pad, in English, and brings the bill at the end. Pay her in play francs.



Café Lila

LAUSANNE · ALL PRICES IN FRANCS

FOOD

	Pizza	8
	Pasta	7
	Soup	5
	Salad	4
	Chicken and rice	9

DRINKS

	Water	1
	Apple juice	4
	Milk	3
	Tea	2

SWEET THINGS

	Cake	5
	Ice cream	4
	Chocolate cake	6

Ask the waiter: "The bill, please."



The Yuck Café

LAUSANNE · ALL PRICES IN FRANCS

FOOD

	Soup with a shoe	100
	Spaghetti with socks	99
	Cold pizza with sand	88
	Salad with a spider	77

DRINKS

	Hot milk with soap	66
	Tea with mud	55

SWEET THINGS

	Cake with onions	44
	Ice cream with ketchup	33

Everything here is terrible. Order it anyway.

SESSION 3 PROP · ORDER SLIPS AND BILLS · CUT AND CLIP TO A SMALL BOARD

ORDER Table no. _____ Waiter _____ Say: "What would you like?"	ORDER Table no. _____ Waiter _____ Say: "What would you like?"
ORDER Table no. _____ Waiter _____ Say: "What would you like?"	ORDER Table no. _____ Waiter _____ Say: "What would you like?"
THE BILL Total _____ francs Say: "That is _____ francs, please."	THE BILL Total _____ francs Say: "That is _____ francs, please."

SESSION 3 PROP · MENU BINGO · ONE CARD EACH

Menu Bingo – card 1

Cross a row and shout "Bingo! Enjoy your meal!"

**Pizza****Soup****Cake****Water****Chicken****Tea****Menu Bingo – card 2**

Cross a row and shout "Bingo! Enjoy your meal!"

**Pasta****Salad****Ice cream****Juice****Rice****Milk**

Take turns being the waiter who calls the dishes. The caller has to say a full sentence – "Would you like a pizza?" – not just the word. The caller is learning more than the player, so make sure she calls at least half the rounds.

Session 4

The Animal Doctor



Body parts, what hurts – and the Grand Show

By the end she can name her body parts, say what hurts, examine a patient and prescribe a cure. Then the last 25 minutes are the Grand Show: all four scenes performed for Mum with printed tickets and a real diploma at the end.

TWELVE WORDS

**head**

κεφάλι

**arm**

μπράτσο

**eyes**

μάτια

**hand**

χέρι

**ear**

αυτί

**leg**

πόδι

**nose**

μύτη

**foot**

πατούσα

**mouth**

στόμα

**tummy**

κοιλιά

**tooth**

δόντι

**medicine**

φάρμακο

THREE THINGS WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

- Reserve the last 25 minutes for the Grand Show – do not let the doctor scenes eat it.
- Show running order: the doorbell scene, the shop, the café, the clinic. Two minutes each. She plays her favourite role in each, you take the other.
- Hand her the diploma at the end with a straight face and a handshake. Ceremony is what makes a seven-year-old want session five.

Greek is printed on your sheets only. Her cards and her script are English-only on purpose – the moment a Greek word sits next to an English one, she reads the Greek and the English becomes decoration.

Session 4 · The Animal Doctor

The ten sentences she will actually use

Say each one, she repeats, twice round. Then hide the sheet – from that point on they only ever appear inside a scene. A sentence drilled at a table is forgotten by Thursday; the same sentence said to a shopkeeper is not.

Good morning, doctor!

Καλημέρα, γιατρέ!

Please sit down.

Καθίστε, παρακαλώ.

What's wrong?

Τι έχεις;

My tummy hurts.

Με πονάει η κοιλιά μου.

Where does it hurt?

Πού πονάει;

Here.

Εδώ.

Open your mouth. Say "aaah".

Άνοιξε το στόμα σου.

Don't worry!

Μην ανησυχείς!

Take this medicine, two times a day.

Πάρε αυτό το φάρμακο, δύο φορές την ημέρα.

You are better now!

Είσαι καλά τώρα!

If she freezes

Say the first two words of her line and stop. Nine times out of ten she finishes it. If she still cannot, say the whole line cheerfully as your own and move on – never leave her standing in silence, and never let the scene stop because of a missing word.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES · SESSION 4 WORD CARDS · FOUR WAYS TO USE THEM ARE ON THE "SESSION SHAPE" SHEET



head



eyes



ear



nose



mouth



tooth



arm



hand



leg



foot



tummy



medicine

Session 4 · The Play

The Animal Doctor

D – the doctor**P – the owner of the patient**

- P** Knock, knock. Good morning, doctor!
- D** Good morning! Please sit down. What's wrong?
- P** My dog is sick.
- D** Oh no! Poor dog. What's wrong with him?
- P** His leg hurts.
- D** Where does it hurt?
- P** Here.
- D** Let me see. Open your mouth, please. Say "aaah".
- P** Aaaaah!
- D** Hmm. Is he hungry?
- P** Yes! He is very hungry!
- D** Don't worry. Take this medicine, two times a day.
- D** And a big dinner tonight!
- P** Thank you, doctor! How much is it?
- D** Ten francs, please.
- P** Here you are. Goodbye!
- D** Goodbye! See you next week!

The set

A towel on the table is the examination bed. The patient is always a stuffed animal – she speaks for it, which is far easier than speaking for herself. A scarf is the doctor's coat.

Props

Stuffed animals · a towel · prescription pad · appointment cards · waiting numbers

Run it three times. You alone with a toy · she takes the first role · swap. Never fewer than three.

Session 4

Games & the silly versions

THREE GAMES

10 MIN

Simon Says

"Simon says touch your nose!" – she does it. "Touch your ear!" without Simon says – she must not move. Fast, physical, and it teaches listening rather than speaking, which is the half that gets neglected.

10 MIN

The Toy Hospital

Four stuffed animals, each with a printed illness card face down. She draws a card, reads what hurts, examines the patient and fills in a prescription slip.

5 MIN

Number Three, Please!

Give the toys the printed waiting-room numbers. The doctor calls "Number three, please!" and only that patient may come. Sneaks the numbers back in one last time.

FOUR SILLY VERSIONS OF THE SAME SCENE

Play these after the straight version has worked twice. The words stay identical; only the world changes. This is where the repetition she needs stops feeling like repetition.

The dragon patient

His nose is too hot. The cure is ten ice creams. "Take ten ice creams, two times a day!"

The doctor who prescribes chocolate

Whatever is wrong, the medicine is chocolate. She will try to make this the real rule of the house.

The patient with one hundred problems

"My head hurts. And my nose hurts. And my foot hurts..."
Run through every body word.

The animal that answers back

The stuffed animal speaks for itself and refuses to open its mouth. The doctor must beg politely.

Home mission after this session: Every evening this week, one toy gets sick and she is the doctor. Two minutes, in English, before the bedtime story. Keep the prescription pad by her bed.

SESSION 4 PROP · PATIENT CARDS · DEAL THEM FACE DOWN

**The dog**

His leg hurts.

**The cat**

Her tooth hurts.

**The bear**

His tummy hurts. He ate ten cakes!

**The rabbit**

Her ear hurts.

**The elephant**

His nose is too long today.

**The dragon**

His nose is very, very hot.

She draws a card, finds the matching stuffed animal, and the scene starts. If she cannot read the sentence yet, whisper it once and let her say it to the doctor herself – never say it for her in front of the patient.

SESSION 4 PROP · PRESCRIPTIONS AND APPOINTMENT CARDS

DOCTOR'S NOTE

Patient _____ Date _____

What is wrong?

Take this medicine:

How many times a day?

Say: "Don't worry! You are better now!"

DOCTOR'S NOTE

Patient _____ Date _____

What is wrong?

Take this medicine:

How many times a day?

Say: "Don't worry! You are better now!"

APPOINTMENT CARD

Patient _____

Day _____

Time _____

Say: "See you next week!"

DOCTOR'S NOTE

Patient _____ Date _____

What is wrong?

Take this medicine:

How many times a day?

Say: "Don't worry! You are better now!"

DOCTOR'S NOTE

Patient _____ Date _____

What is wrong?

Take this medicine:

How many times a day?

Say: "Don't worry! You are better now!"

APPOINTMENT CARD

Patient _____

Day _____

Time _____

Say: "See you next week!"

SESSION 4 PROP · WAITING-ROOM NUMBERS · ONE PER PATIENT

1	2
3	4
5	6

Give each toy a number and sit them in a row. The doctor calls "Number four, please!" and only that patient may come. Anyone who comes out of turn is sent back with "Sorry! Number two first!"

L a u s a n n e

The Grand Show

Four scenes in English, performed by Lila and Papa.
Doors open at the end of session four. Admission: one ticket.

1**The New Neighbour**

A stranger knocks on the door. Who is she?

2**The Little Shop**

Two apples, some bread, and the correct change.

3**The Little Café**

One pizza, one apple juice, and the bill.

4**The Animal Doctor**

A dog with a bad leg is cured in under two minutes.

Running order

Two minutes per scene, no more. She picks her favourite role in each one and you take the other. Keep the scripts within reach but out of sight – she will want them and will mostly not need them.

The audience's job

Mum claps loudly after every scene and asks one question in English at the end: "What is your name?" Being asked by somebody other than you is the real test of the four sessions.

SESSION 4 PROP · SHOW TICKETS · SHE HANDS THEM OUT BEFORE THE PERFORMANCE

The English Play Pack presents

The Grand Show

Four scenes in English · Lausanne

Guest: _____

Seat

1

Admit one

The English Play Pack presents

The Grand Show

Four scenes in English · Lausanne

Guest: _____

Seat

2

Admit one

The English Play Pack presents

The Grand Show

Four scenes in English · Lausanne

Guest: _____

Seat

3

Admit one

The English Play Pack presents

The Grand Show

Four scenes in English · Lausanne

Guest: _____

Seat

4

Admit one



Diploma of English

AWARDED TO

Lila

who in four sessions learned to say hello to a stranger, run a shop, serve a whole café and cure a dog – entirely in English, and mostly in a funny voice.



Papa · the teacher

Date

The home missions

Two minutes a day, every day, with a prop in her hand. This page matters more than any single session – a language grows on daily contact, not on long Sundays. Tick a box each day.

AFTER	WHAT SHE DOES	MON-SUN
Session 1	Every morning this week, the first words of the day are English. She knocks on your bedroom door: "Good morning! How are you?" You answer, then ask her back.	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Session 2	She is the cashier at dinner this week. Nobody gets bread until they ask her in English and pay with a play note. She gives the change and says the price.	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Session 3	Saturday breakfast, she is the waiter. She takes the whole family's order on the printed pad, in English, and brings the bill at the end. Pay her in play francs.	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Session 4	Every evening this week, one toy gets sick and she is the doctor. Two minutes, in English, before the bedtime story. Keep the prescription pad by her bed.	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

The rule that makes missions work

The mission is a job with real consequences inside the family, not homework. Nobody gets bread at dinner until they have asked the cashier in English. If the family plays along, she practises without being asked; if the family forgets, the mission dies in three days.

Keep the box

Everything cut out of this pack – cards, money, menu, prescriptions, the hat – lives in one box that only comes out for English. Never leave the props lying about. Something that appears only for the game keeps the value of the game.

What comes after session four

Four sessions gets a beginner to about sixty words and eight sentence patterns she can actually use. That is a real result, and it is also fragile. The engine of this pack is not the vocabulary, it is the format – so keep the format and change the world.

FOUR MORE WORLDS, SAME NINETY MINUTES

5 • The train station

Tickets, "Where are you going?", "To Geneva, please", platform numbers. Numbers get a second life and you can rehearse a real journey.

6 • The birthday party

"Happy birthday!", presents, "Can I have a piece of cake?", "How old are you?" Recycles almost everything from sessions one to three.

7 • The lost dog

Descriptions: big, small, black, white, "Have you seen my dog?" This is where adjectives and colours belong.

8 • The hotel

"A room for two nights, please", floors, keys, breakfast at eight. Combines the shop, the café and the numbers in one scene.

THREE THINGS NOT TO DO

- **Do not start writing yet.**

She is learning to read in Greek and in French at the same time. A third spelling system now is one too many. Everything here is spoken; the words on her cards are pictures with a label, not a spelling lesson.

- **Do not test her.**

No "what is the English for...?" out of the blue. Ask inside a scene or not at all – a question with the hat on is a game, the same question without it is an exam.

- **Do not compete with school French.**

If she mixes French into English, let it pass. Mixing is a normal stage for a trilingual child, and correcting it is how you teach her to stop volunteering to speak.